

Chris and Matt: A Proposal for Working Together

For Matt Campbell, from Chris Habetler. September 29, 2026.

Matt,

First, thank you for asking. I've loved working with you these last few months, and I really appreciate the trust behind it.

On the 22nd you asked what I could do, what it would look like, and what I would charge, so I took a stab at it. Read it as a starting point. I'm looking forward to talking it through and figuring out the best path together, and I expect we'll change a good bit of it.

What This Is For

- A clear working arrangement between the two of us, built on the respect we already have for each other.
- Helping you build EdTech Expertz into the empire you've talked about.
- The right level of support for this moment, while September's pace and your cash reserve are both real.
- Adjusting it as we go, so it grows when the business does.

I want to earn my place on your team, and I want you to feel completely comfortable asking me for whatever you need.

Why It Pays for Itself

The idea is simple. If I take enough off your plate, you get to:

- spend your time on the work only you can do, the strategy and product thinking your clients hire you for
- step out of the day-to-day details and have room to think
- hand things off with confidence that they'll come back done, and done well

That's what lets EdTech Expertz take on more clients without you working more hours. Here's the math on one. Say this helps you go from four clients to five, and the fifth is the size of ClasseE, \$8,500 a month. At that point my fee would be \$3,775, and EdTech Expertz brings in \$4,725 a month more than it does today.

It isn't a wash, and it shouldn't be. Five clients is more to manage than four, even with help, which is why most of the new money stays with you.

What I'd Take On

Here's what I've heard you need so far:

- In-depth research whenever you need it: crosswalks, diligence readouts, prep briefs on prospective clients, and people maps. This is the "30 people at Canvas" version, where the research comes back with more than you asked for.
- Running the referral network day to day: finding and vetting members, onboarding, a one-page card on each company, monthly check-ins, running the monthly meeting with you, a weekly digest so you can say yes or no in one pass, and the tracker and shared diligence folder in your Drive. Members can still come straight to you, and your clients still go through you to reach the network.

- The school-side voice in client work: sessions like Forward Edge on 10/1, messaging and language work, feedback on decks and pitches, and bringing in expert reviewers when a client needs one.
- Introductions in both directions.

Anything else that helps EdTech Expertz grow, send it my way. For the first month, my priorities would be prep briefs on your five parked leads, the member list cleaned up, the company cards, and the first weekly digest.

On time, I'm picturing about a day a week to start, more in heavy weeks and less in light ones. That's a rough expectation, not a limit. A short weekly check-in where you set the priorities keeps us honest on it.

Everything I build lives in your Drive and belongs to you, including the agent prompt you asked about in July. The company relationships, approving intros, contracts, fees, and the final call on positioning stay yours.

Other Ways I Could Help

None of these are part of the starting arrangement. They're things I'd love to do as the business grows, and when one of them is paid for by a client, we'd agree on my share before it starts.

- Representing EdTech Expertz with school leaders and at conferences, or co-presenting with you.
- Joining first meetings with prospective clients to give the school-side read on their product.
- Outreach to the mid-size publishers and platforms on your target list.
- Working directly with people on a client's team (sales, customer success, product) on how they serve schools: onboarding, implementation, pilots, and renewals.
- School-leader feedback panels on a client's product.
- Training a client's sales team on how school leaders actually buy.
- Help with approvals and procurement, like the New York sponsor list and BOCES route from the Forward Edge readout.
- AI enablement for a client's team, and L&D or association work when you're ready to go after it.

Pay

- My monthly fee starts at \$2,500.
- It grows with new business. My fee goes up by 15% of any new monthly retainer business EdTech Expertz signs, until it reaches \$5,000, which is where I'd want it to end up. A client the size of ClassE adds \$1,275, and a few smaller clients count the same way as one bigger one. AAP counts as part of today's business, not as new business.
- On top of that, 20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on network deals. That's the "grows as the sales these individuals bring in grows" piece you described on 9/16. It's a bigger share of a narrower slice than the 1% of everything you floated, so it never touches your core consulting.

Both start on October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later, and the network share covers deals that come in after that. Benchmark and Forward Edge on 10/1 are on me no matter when we start. If \$2,500 is too much for October, tell me what works and we'll start there. The rest stays the same.

A network deal means a deal you close through a member intro you approved, logged in the tracker when you approved it. I'll never pitch members, since you've been clear this can't turn into a sales engine. My own intros stay under the August agreement, and if an intro fits both, the August agreement applies.

If the Business Changes

Your business is going to keep changing, and this should change with it. A few I can see coming:

- One very large client. A client paying \$500,000 a year would take my fee straight to \$5,000 and would probably change what you need from me. We'd sit down and reset both.
- Project work, courses, speaking, or a book. These aren't monthly retainers, so they don't move my fee. If I help build one, we agree on my share before it starts.
- A client leaves, or AAP slips. We talk about it at the next check-in rather than letting a formula decide. If AAP hasn't signed by the end of October, let's talk about starting anyway.
- You bring on more people. My role would probably shift, and we'd work out the new one together.

The First Three Months

Let's run this October through December and then sit down in January. We'd look at what I delivered, what it freed up for you, where the business and the network are, and whether the fee and the time still match the work. Then we reset whatever needs it.

Either of us can end it with 30 days' notice, and you'd get a clean handoff. The network share keeps paying for 12 months on deals already logged.

Items for Conversation

1. A full-time role. I'm in late rounds for a full-time role at a charter network, and there may be others. If one happens, you'll hear it from me first, and I want to keep doing both. What we'd work out together is timing (the network check-ins are the piece most tied to the school day) and anything a school employer would want to clear, since the network puts vendors in front of schools.
2. What you usually keep on a network deal. That number tells us whether 20% is right.
3. How many hours a week research and the network take you now.
4. The Classe advisory. You asked on 9/16 what I'd need. My starting thought is \$3,000 a month, and I'd want your read on how to frame it with Joe and where that work ends and my work for you begins.
5. Which of the other ways to help, if any, you'd want to try first.

Thank you again for asking me. Obviously there's a lot here, and I'm really looking forward to talking it through and figuring out what works best for you. Clarity is king, so push on any of it.

Chris